

The Primary decomposition theorem.

Let T be a linear operator on the finite-dimensional vector space V over a field F .
Let P be the minimal polynomial for T with the irreducible decomposition

$$P = p_1^{r_1} \cdot p_2^{r_2} \cdots p_k^{r_k}$$

Then,

$$V = \bigoplus_{i=1}^k \ker p_i^{r_i}(T) \text{ and each } \ker p_i^{r_i}(T) \text{ is invariant } T.$$

Moreover, the restriction of T by $\ker p_i^{r_i}(T)$ has the minimal polynomial as $p_i^{r_i}$.

Proof. For each $1 \leq i \leq k$, define

$$f_i = \prod_{j \neq i} p_j^{r_j}$$

Since p_i 's are prime, $f_1, \dots, f_k$ are relatively prime,

$$f_1 g_1 + \dots + f_k g_k = 1 \text{ for some polynomials } g_1, \dots, g_k.$$

And, clearly, for $i \neq j$, $f_i f_j$ is divided by P .

For each $1 \leq i \leq k$, put $E_i = f_i(T) g_i(T)$. Then,

$$E_1 + E_2 + \dots + E_k = I \text{ and } E_i E_j = 0 \text{ if } i \neq j,$$

because $f_i f_j$ is divided by P , so is $f_i f_j g_i g_j$. Thus each E_i is a projection.

In fact, these $E_1, \dots, E_k$ are resolution of identity, these images decompose V .

And, to show $\text{Im } E_i = \ker p_i^{r_i}$ for each $1 \leq i \leq k$, observe that

$$\alpha \in \text{Im } E_i \Rightarrow E_i(\alpha) = \alpha \Rightarrow p_i(T)^{r_i} \alpha = p_i(T)^{r_i} E_i(\alpha) = p_i(T)^{r_i} f_i(T) g_i(T) \alpha = 0.$$

so $\alpha \in \ker p_i^{r_i}(T)$. Conversely,

$$\alpha \in \ker p_i^{r_i}(T) \Rightarrow f_j(T) g_j(T) \alpha = 0 \text{ for } j \neq i \Rightarrow E_j(\alpha) = 0$$

so $\alpha \in \text{Im } E_i$. Therefore, $\text{Im } E_i = \ker p_i^{r_i}(T)$ for all $1 \leq i \leq k$.

The invariance is given by: $\alpha \in \ker p_i^{r_i}(T) \Leftrightarrow p_i^{r_i}(T) \alpha = 0 \Rightarrow p_i^{r_i}(T) T \alpha = T \cdot p_i^{r_i}(T) \alpha = 0$.

Let $T_i: \ker p_i^{r_i}(T) \rightarrow \ker p_i^{r_i}(T): \alpha \mapsto T \alpha$, for each $1 \leq i \leq k$.

Clearly, $p_i^{r_i}(T_i) = 0$, and, if $g(T) = 0$, then $g(T) f_i(T) = 0$, so $g f_i$

so $g f_i$ is divided by $p_i^{r_i} \cdot f_i$, so g is divided by $p_i^{r_i}$. $\square$

Thm. Let T be a linear operator on the finite dimensional V over a field V .

If the minimal polynomial of T splits over F , then there exist diagonalizable D , nilpotent N , satisfying $T = D + N$ and $DN = ND$.

Moreover, such D and N are unique, and both are polynomial in T .

Proof. Let $P(x) = (x - c_1)^{r_1} \cdots (x - c_k)^{r_k}$ be the minimal polynomial of T .

By the Primary decomposition Theorem, there exist resolution of identity:

$$E_1 + \cdots + E_k = I \text{ and } E_i E_j = \delta_{ij} E_i \text{ satisfying}$$

Each $1 \leq i \leq k$, $\text{Im } E_i = \ker(T - c_i I)^{r_i}$. Define $D = c_1 E_1 + \cdots + c_k E_k$ and $N = T - D$.

Then,

$$T = T E_1 + \cdots + T E_k$$

$$D = c_1 E_1 + \cdots + c_k E_k$$

$$N = (T - c_1 I) E_1 + \cdots + (T - c_k I) E_k.$$

By the orthogonality, for $r = \max\{r_1, \dots, r_k\}$,

$$N^r = (T - c_1 I)^r E_1 + \cdots + (T - c_k I)^r E_k = 0,$$

because each $1 \leq i \leq k$, $(x - c_i)^{r_i}$ is the minimal polynomial of the restriction $T|_{\text{Im } E_i}$.

So N is nilpotent, and D is diagonalizable, directly.